

Challenge Based Learning

Team 24:

- Miguel Grilo | University of Évora
- Milica Stanković | University of Belgrade
- Weizhuo Sun | University of Rennes
- Yushay Aizaz | Eötvös Loránd Tudományegyetem
- Helmeczi Dávid | Eötvös Loránd Tudományegyetem
- Ronghao Jin | Universidad Politécnica de Madrid
- Sara Alonso | Universidad Politécnica de Madrid

Challenge-Based Learning (CBL), PHASE 2

3. ACT – Develop a Solution to the Company Challenge

3.1 Solution Concept (direct response to the company challenge)

Proposed Solution:

The proposed solution is divided into two expansion strategies, the Farmit Trust-Bridge and a Phased Regional Pilot focusing on the Farmeet B2B model as a market-entry scout.

Instead of a full-scale launch of the Rent-a-Garden model, which requires high logistics and established trust, Farmit will first deploy Farmeet smart vending machines in corporate hubs of target cities. These machines will introduce the brand's quality. Simultaneously, the digital platform will be upgraded with an interactive portal, to connect Farmers and Consumers, that uses localized storytelling and transparency data (pesticide-free verification) to bridge the trust gap identified in Phase 1.

How it addresses the Strategic Challenge:

This solution directly answers the challenge of expanding without diluting trust or fairness. By using Farmeet as a low-risk entry point, the company can establish its quality standards in a new market before asking consumers for the high commitment of a garden subscription.

Connection to Investigation Findings:

- **Addressing Needs and Barriers:** Our investigation highlighted that trust is not automatically transferable (Insight 2.5.1). The Trust-Bridge addresses this by moving away from generic marketing to localized community engagement. It turns

the barrier of low regional awareness into an opportunity to build a brand from the ground up through physical Farmeet units.

- **Inspiration from Insights:** Insight 2.5.2 directly inspired the Interactive Portal. We realized that for a user in another country to trust a farmer they haven't met, the digital interface must provide visible proof of quality and a sense of connection.
- **Resolving Root Causes and Mitigating Risks:** The root cause of expansion failure in agri-food is often the high cost of localizing supply chains (Insight 2.5.3). By leading with a hybrid model, Farmeet + Interactive Portal, we mitigate the financial risk of setting up massive logistic networks immediately. We leverage the scalability opportunity discovered in Phase 2 by using the B2B side of business to prepare the market for the B2C subscription model later on.

Relevance and Support:

This concept is supported by our findings that Farmit's strength lies in its responsible entrepreneurship. The solution doesn't just sell vegetables, it exports a verified system of transparency. By standardizing the digital proof of quality, we ensure that Farmer Fairness remains a measurable fact, not just a slogan, as the company moves abroad.

3.2 Implementation Plan

(Weeks 1-4): Discovery & Sourcing

Target Selection: Identify 1-2 primary corporate hubs in a specific neighbouring Balkan or Southeast European market.

Local Supply Scouting: Identify a small group of local farmers in the target region who can immediately meet Farmit's strict quality standards.

B2B Outreach: Secure partnerships with 2-3 workplaces willing to host the initial Farmeet smart vending machines.

(Weeks 3-6): Prototyping the Digital Trust-Bridge

Interactive Portal MVP: Develop a lightweight mockup of the portal focusing on localized farmer storytelling and pesticide-free verification.

Early Testing Group:

- **New Market Focus Group:** A small group of representative urban consumers recruited strictly from the new target market. They will interact with the MVP to validate whether the digital storytelling alone can establish baseline trust for an unfamiliar brand without the physical farm experience.

(Weeks 7-12): The Farmeet Pilot

Hardware Deployment: Install a limited run (3-5 units) of Farmeet smart vending machines in the secured corporate locations to offer healthy meals.

Portal Integration: Place QR codes on the vending machines and packaging, linking directly to the Interactive Portal MVP.

Early Testing Group:

- **Frontline Employees:** The employees in the selected workplaces. They serve as the primary testers, validating if the physical food quality combined with digital transparency builds enough brand trust to eventually introduce the B2C subscription model.

(Weeks 13-14): Review & Refine

Measure user engagement metrics from the portal and gather direct feedback from the corporate employees using the Farmeet machines. Use this data to evaluate if trust is successfully transferring across borders before scaling up.

4. SHARE – Communicate Results

4.1 Final Presentation

Hi everyone. We are Team 24, and today we're going to present our strategy for Farmit. As we know, Farmit has built an incredible subscription-based 'rent-a-garden' model in Serbia, deeply rooted in consumer trust, pesticide-free food, and fair pay for farmers. The challenge they face now is: how can they scale into neighboring Balkan and Southeast European markets without losing this core identity? And specifically, how should they balance their traditional B2C subscription model with their new B2B vending machine initiative, 'Farmed'?

During our investigation phase, we realized a crucial insight: trust cannot simply be copy-pasted across borders. It has to be actively built. Our research and evidence showed that regional consumers have low awareness of the brand, and a full-scale B2C 'rent-a-garden' launch right away would be logistically complex and highly risky. We discovered that to bridge this gap, Farmit needs a seamless digital experience that provides visible proof of quality and localized storytelling.

That is why our proposed solution is the 'Farmit Trust-Bridge'—a phased regional pilot that uses the B2B 'Farmed' model as a market-entry scout. Instead of launching the complex subscription model on day one, Farmit will install Farmeet smart vending machines in corporate hubs. To solve the trust barrier, we paired this physical product with an 'Interactive Portal'. Consumers will be able to scan a QR code on the machine to access localized storytelling and pesticide-free verification, directly connecting them with the local farmers who grew their food.

To make this happen, our implementation plan starts small, realistic, and low-risk. In the first four weeks, Farmit will scout 1 or 2 corporate hubs in a target country and partner with a small group of local farmers who meet their strict standards. By weeks 7 to 12, we will

deploy a limited pilot of 3 to 5 Far meat machines. Our early testing group will be the frontline employees in these workplaces. They will test both the physical meals and the digital Interactive Portal MVP, allowing us to measure user engagement and validate if trust is successfully transferring.

In conclusion, our Trust-Bridge approach directly answers Farmit's challenge. It allows the company to enter new markets with low financial risk while actively building the community trust and farmer fairness they are known for. By the time they are ready to launch the full subscription model, the market will already know and trust the Farmit brand. We are not just exporting vegetables; we are exporting a verified system of transparency. Thank you so much for listening, and we're looking forward to your feedback.